

Up the rails, *down the coast*

BKK

→ Bangkok

→ Chiang Mai

→ Krabi

→ Khao Sok

→ Bangkok

→

EK374 · 07:35

2 NIGHTS

3 NIGHTS

3 NIGHTS

3 NIGHTS

1 NIGHT

BKK

EK373 · 20:45

◆ At a glance

NOVEMBER 2026

The whole trip on one grid — colour-coded by region, travel days flagged. You land **Sunday the 1st** and fly home Saturday the 14th.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1 LAND 07:35	2 BANGKOK	3 NIGHT TRAIN	4 CHIANG MAI	5 U CHIANG MAI	6 U CHIANG MAI	7 FLY SOUTH
8 CENTARA	9 CENTARA	10 TRANSFER IN	11 360 ISSARA	12 360 ISSARA	13 FLY TO BKK	14 FLY 20:45

Bangkok

Chiang Mai

Krabi

Khao Sok

→ marks a travel / transit day

Land at 07:35 and give yourself a soft start: temple-hop the old city, eat your way down the Chao Phraya, and shake off the flight before the **night train north**.

SUN

1

NOV

ARRIVE

Land & ease in

- Clear immigration; ARL to **Makkasan**, then MRT to **Lumphini** — that exit is 300 m from the door, which beats the walk from Ploen Chit with cases.
- **Check-in isn't until 15:00**, so leave the bags at the desk and go straight out — you'll have most of the day before a room exists.
- Late morning: **Wat Pho** and its giant reclining Buddha, then a foot massage at the temple's own school.
- Sunset boat on the Chao Phraya; riverside dinner with **Wat Arun** lit up across the water. Early night — you'll have been travelling 21 hours across a 12-hour shift.

STAY Ritz-Carlton · 90034653

ARR EK374 07:35 · H2M5FJ

check-in 15:00 — ask early

Grand old Bangkok

- Open-of-day at the **Grand Palace & Wat Phra Kaew** (Emerald Buddha), before heat and crowds.
- Ferry across to **Wat Arun**; climb the central prang for the view.
- Afternoon: Jim Thompson House or a cool-down spa hour. Evening: **Yaowarat** Chinatown street-food crawl.

STAY Ritz-Carlton

MRT Lumphini 300 m



TUE

3

NOV

DEPART

Markets, then the rails

- Either an **early** start — the **Maeklong railway + Damnoen Saduak** half-day leaves around 06:30 and the market is over by late morning — or a slow morning and a guided food tour instead. Not both.
- Afternoon: coffee, a massage, and pack an overnight bag you can reach on the train.
- **18:40**: board Special Express #9 at Krung Thep Aphiwat — e-tickets issued. Dinner in the dining car, berths down.

TRAIN #9 18:40 → 07:15 · 34511470

at station by 18:10

SLEEPER #9 ·
TICKETED

STATE RAILWAY OF THAILAND ·
SPECIAL EXPRESS

NIGHT 03

Sleep on the move

18:40

≈ 13 h · 751 km

07:15

KRUNG THEP APHIWAT

overnight

CHIANG MAI

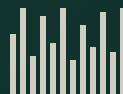
Bangkok · Tue 3 Nov

Wed 4 Nov (+1)

CLASS 2nd A/C sleeper × 2

REF ...6901 / ...6902

KTW → CGM



Be at the station by
18:10.

Wake up in the mountains. Lanna temples, an **ethical elephant day**, jungle waterfalls and cool air — the exhale after Bangkok's heat. Three nights at **U Chiang Mai**, inside the moat.

The room is booked from **Tue 3 Nov**, the night you're on the train. That night is paid for deliberately: the room is already yours when you step off the sleeper at 07:15 on the 4th, so you walk in and check in on time whatever the train does. The rate is **non-refundable**, so the dates can't be shifted. Breakfast isn't included — about **THB 399** each for the buffet.

WED

4

NOV

ARRIVE

Off the train, into the Old City

- Arrive 07:15; the room is already held from last night, so go straight there and drop your bags.
- Temple wander on foot: **Wat Chedi Luang**, **Wat Phra Singh**, and the quiet lanes between.
- Evening: the Night Bazaar and a bowl of **khao soi**, the north's signature curry noodle.

STAY U Chiang Mai · 2535552787

arr 07:15

THU

5

NOV

DAY TRIP

Elephants, done right

- Full day at an **ethical sanctuary** (Elephant Nature Park and similar) — feeding and observing, no riding.
- Back by evening; unwind in **Nimman**, the café and craft-beer district.

STAY U Chiang Mai

book the sanctuary ahead



FRI

6

NOV

EXPLORE

Mountain temple, then slow

- Morning: **Wat Phra That Doi Suthep**, the gold chedi on the mountain above the city.
- Afternoon: the Old City at walking pace — a market, a massage, one more bowl of khao soi.
- **Or swap the whole day for Doi Inthanon**, but treat it as a full day out: it's 2-2½ h each way, so you'd leave about 07:00 and skip Doi Suthep.
- Repack for the tropics tonight — tomorrow starts early.

STAY U Chiang Mai

early start tomorrow — away by 06:00



Fly Chiang Mai → Krabi

CNX → KBV · FD3072 · direct · ticketed

Sat 7 Nov · morning

≈ 2 h in the air

03 / 05

Krabi — *the Andaman*

SAT 7 → TUE 10 NOV

Swap mountains for limestone and sea. [Longtail boats](#), [castaway beaches](#), and karst cliffs rising straight out of turquoise water. Three nights at **Centara Ao Nang**, on the beach.

You land well before check-in. FD3072 puts you in Krabi at 09:55 and the room isn't ready until 15:00, so plan to leave the bags at reception and start the day on the beach. Two things worth asking the hotel for when you arrive: a room **away from the drainage canal** that runs between the wings — it's a known smell complaint — and confirmation of the pool-access room you booked. Rate is **non-refundable**; breakfast is extra, around **THB 325–650** each.

SAT

7

NOV

ARRIVE

Fly south, feet in the sand

- Morning flight down; transfer to **Ao Nang** — about 30 minutes from the airport.
- Afternoon on the beach, first Andaman sunset, a long seafood dinner.

FLY FD3072 CNX-KBV · UYTUHF

STAY Centara Ao Nang · 2535573436

SUN

8

NOV

ISLANDS

Island-hop

- Full-day boat trip: the **Hong Islands** lagoon or the classic **4-Islands** — Phra Nang cave beach, Tup, Chicken, Poda.
- Snorkel, swim, beach lunch; back for sunset.
- **The most weather-dependent day of the trip.** Early November seas are still unsettled and boat trips are the first thing cancelled — if it's rough, swap with tomorrow and do the inland day instead.

STAY Centara Ao Nang

reef-safe sunscreen

MON

9

NOV

EXPLORE

Cliffs, jungle & steam

- Sunrise option: the **Tiger Cave Temple's** 1,260 steps for the summit view over the plains.
- Or the inland **Emerald Pool & hot springs** in the rainforest; easy afternoon back at the beach.

STAY Centara Ao Nang

drive to Khao Sok tomorrow

Transfer Krabi → 360° Issara



included in package · meet 500Rai Pier Office, Chiew Larn

Tue 10 Nov · boat 12:00 or 15:30
≈ 2 h road + 1.5 h boat

04 / 05

Khao Sok — *on the lake*

TUE 10 → FRI 13 NOV

Three nights **floating on Cheow Lan Lake** at 360° Issara, ringed by limestone towers in one of the oldest rainforests on earth. The centrepiece of the trip.

Transfers are included. The package covers a private car from Krabi (~2 h) to the 500Rai Pier Office at Chiew Larn, then a 1.5 h longtail. Boats out to the resort leave the pier at **12:00 or 15:30 only**. Pack small — you climb down stairs to the boat, and big cases can stay at the pier office. Bring **THB 340 each in cash** for the national park fee.

The way out is the tight one. On the 13th the resort runs a single scheduled boat back at **10:30**, and it feeds a non-refundable flight the same afternoon. Reconfirm it with the resort the day before, and don't rely on arranging something later. One thing about the rooms while you're here: the **air-conditioning runs 12:00–06:00 only**, and that applies to all three nights, not just one.

TUE

10

NOV

ARRIVE

Drive, then the longtail

- Leave Krabi by **09:00** — it's about **2 h by road** to Chiew Larn and you want slack at the pier for the park fee and getting bags down to the boat, not a dead-on arrival for **12:00**.
- **1.5 h by longtail** across the lake, sightseeing on the way; the resort appears like a floating village.
- Check in from 14:00, swim off the deck, set dinner over the water.
17:00: wildlife safari & sunset cruise — miss the 12:00 boat and the next is 15:30, which costs you this.

STAY 360° Issara · 0592406

3-Night Essence · all-in

WED

11

NOV

THE LAKE

Nowhere to be

- **Pakarang Cave Trail** leaves at **09:45** — 1.5 km trek plus a bamboo raft (THB 200 each, cash). The one fixed thing today.
- After that, nothing: kayak straight off your own balcony — each room has one.
- Swim in the fresh water, read, watch the light move across the karsts.

STAY 360° Issara

A/C 12:00-06:00 only

THU

12

NOV

DAWN

Last full day on the water

- Morning lake sightseeing — gibbons, hornbills and elephants along the shoreline.
- **Prakai Petch Cave Trail** — swamp forest, small waterfalls, glittering cave. The resort lists it as **Mon/Wed/Sat**, and the 12th is a Thursday — **confirm this one on arrival** rather than counting on it.
- Last sunset cruise at 17:00. Pack tonight — **check-out is 10:00**.

STAY 360° Issara

check-out 10:00



Boat, car, then fly → Bangkok

360° Issara → Chiew Larn → Surat Thani (URT) → Don Mueang (DMK)

Fri 13 Nov • boat 10:30

SL741 16:40 → 17:55

One night back in the capital at **Grande Centre Point Terminal 21**, on the Asok interchange, then a *half-day in the city* — check-out at noon, bags at the desk, and the 20:45 flight to make.

FRI

13

NOV

RETURN

Off the lake, into the city

- Breakfast, check out at 10:00, scheduled boat at 10:30, car to Surat Thani — at URT about 13:00.
- **SL741 16:40 → 17:55** into **Don Mueang, Terminal 2** — roughly three hours in hand at Surat Thani.
- **Take the SRT Red Line** to Krung Thep Aphiwat, then the MRT to Sukhumvit. It's a Friday and the roads will be at their worst; the train is elevated and ignores them. Reckon on being checked in around 19:00–19:30.
- Dinner around **Terminal 21** — the hotel sits on top of the Asok interchange, so you needn't go far.

FLY SL741 URT-DMK 16:40 · OWUPXU

STAY Grande Centre Point T21 · 73523066938869



SAT

14

NOV

DEPART

Fly home

- Check out at 12:00 and leave the bags at the desk. You have five hours, so keep it central — **ICONSIAM**, Jim Thompson House, a last massage. Not Ayutthaya; it needs the better part of a day.
- Leave by **17:00** for Suvarnabhumi. From Asok it's one MRT stop to Phetchaburi and straight onto the **Airport Rail Link at Makkasan** — about 30 minutes, and no traffic to allow for.
- **20:45**: EK373 to Dubai, then JFK at 08:15 Sunday.

DEP EK373 20:45 · H2M5FJ

at airport by ~17:45

Before you go

- 01 **Train #9 is ticketed.** Two 2nd-class A/C berths (res. 34511470), Bangkok 18:40 → Chiang Mai 07:15.
- 02 **Booked.** Emirates H2M5FJ, Ritz-Carlton (90034653), Sleeper #9, U Chiang Mai (2535552787), FD3072 (UYTUHF), Centara Ao Nang (2535573436), 360° Issara (0592406), SL741 (OWUPXU), Grande Centre Point T21 (73523066938869). All thirteen nights and every flight are now booked. The Krabi transfer is included in the package. **No activity is** — the elephant sanctuary on the 5th is the one to lock in first, as it sells out in season.
- 03 **Timing is good, not guaranteed.** Early November is the front edge of the cool, dry season, and Khao Sok is at its lushest because the rain has only just stopped. The Andaman is still drying out — expect a wet afternoon or two, and treat the island day as the one to move.
- 04 **Mind the two airports.** You arrive on the 13th at **Don Mueang** but fly home on the 14th from **Suvarnabhumi**. There's no connection between them — you sleep in the city — but don't turn up at the wrong one on Saturday.
- 05 **Cash for the park fee.** THB 340 per person on arrival at Khao Sok, plus THB 200 each for the Pakarang cave trail — not included.
- 06 **This is a shape, not a script.** The beds and the flights are fixed now, and non-refundable — but nothing inside a day is. Swap the order, drop what doesn't appeal, and bend the days to your energy.

DOWNLOAD ITINERARY (PDF)

DOWNLOAD CALENDAR (PDF, PRINT LANDSCAPE)

// 14 days · 13 nights · Bangkok — Chiang Mai — Krabi — Khao Sok — Bangkok · Nov 2026